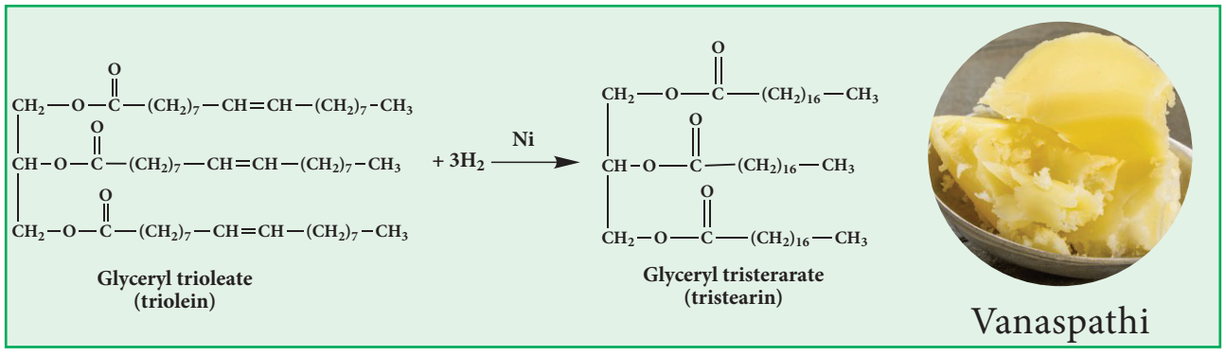


Figure 6.9 Hydrogenation of unsaturated fatty acids

iii. Saponification:

The process of hydrolysis of fat by aqueous alkali (NaOH or KOH) to yield glycerol and the salt of fatty acid (soap) is called saponification or alkaline hydrolysis of esters. Soaps are sodium or potassium salts of long chain fatty acids.

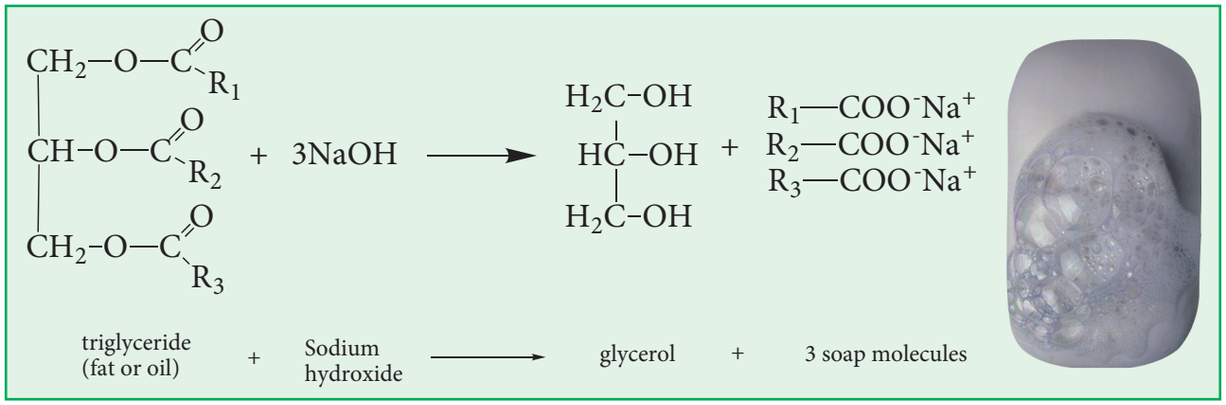


Figure 6.10 Saponification reaction of fatty acids

iv. Halogenation:

Unsaturated fatty acids have the ability to bind halogens like Cl_2, Br_2 and I_2 to their double bonds. It is a very important property which determines the degree of unsaturation of the fat or oil that determines its biological value.

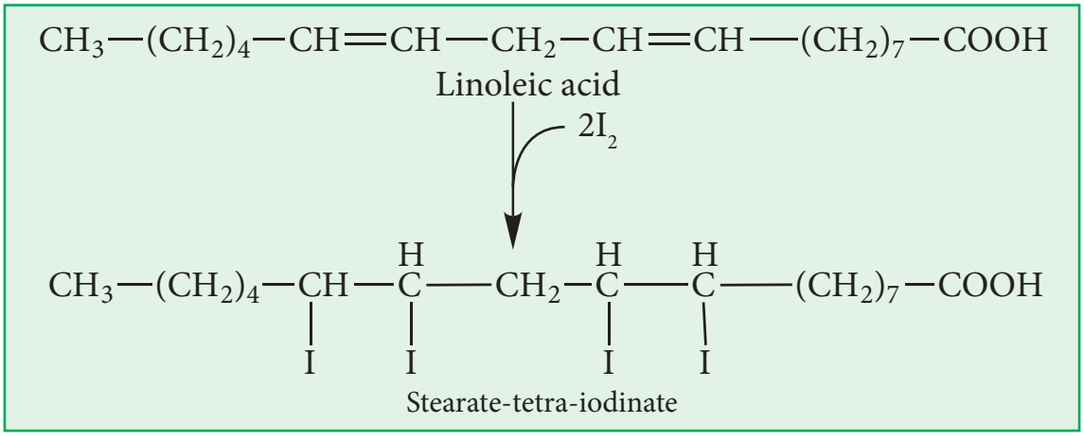


Figure 6.11 Halogenation reaction of fatty acids

Unit 6.indd 160 21-05-2018 15:10:49